7.3 Preparation of a Traditional Tamilnadu Cuisine

Aim: To know about the preparation of traditional Chettinad cuisine.

Equipment needed: Vessels, kadai, cutter, spoons, cups, mixie/blender.

Unique Features of Chettinad Cuisine

- The traditional Chettinad dishes mostly used locally available spices like the star anise, pepper, kalpasi and marattimokku.
- Chettinad kitchen is one of the largest and most important places in a Karaikudi house.
- Traditional meals served by Chettinad style on banana leaves follow a specific protocol.

Formulation of Recipe

Chicken Chettinad

Ingredients		Quantity
Chicken	:	500g
Onions	:	150g
Tomatoes	:	100g
Cinnamon	:	2g
Cardamom	:	1
Cloves	:	2g
Cumin seeds	:	5g
Curry leaves	:	2g
Coriander leaves	:	2g
Turmeric powder	:	10g
Salt	:	As required



▲ Plate 7.7 Chettinad Chicken

For grinding

Onions	:	100g
Ginger	:	50g
Garlic	:	50g
Fennel seeds	:	50g
Cumin seeds	:	50g
Pepper corns	:	25g
Red chillies	:	10g
Coconut	:	100g

Method

- Grind the ingredients to a paste.
- Clean and cut the chicken into pieces. Marinate the chicken with the paste.
- Chop the tomatoes, coriander leaves and the onions.
- Heat oil and add the cinnamon, cardamom, cloves and cumin seeds.
- Add the chopped onions and the curry leaves.
- Add the tomatoes and sauté for 5 minutes.
- Add the marinated chicken and turmeric powder.

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